

CONTROL FLOW IN PYTHON

Key Terms and Definitions

- » **Expression:** Any valid piece of code that evaluates to something.
- » **if Statements:** Expressions that evaluate to a Boolean result (True or False) and test a conditional statement, such as comparing two objects. You can write code that operates a certain way only if the **if** statement evaluates to True. You can use the **elif** (else if) condition to link multiple **if** statements and the **else** condition to tell your code to do something different if the **if** statement evaluates to False.
- » **while Loops:**
You can think about the **while** statement as a repeated **if** statement, which first evaluates the **while** expression before deciding whether to execute its code block. A **while** loop is generally used in Python if it is not known when the looping will stop or how many iterations the loop will require. The **while** loop is in many ways the most basic looping construct. All other loops can be rewritten as a while loop.
- » **for Loops:** A **while** loop in which the "while" statement is automatically set to be a specific number of iterations.
- » **raw_input** : A built-in Python function that prompts the user for text input and returns the user's input as a string.
- » **range** : A built-in Python function that returns a list of numbers between given starting and ending points in defined increments.

Guiding Questions

1. Name a few situations in which you would use a **while** loop versus a **for** loop, and vice versa.
2. What do we mean when we say a piece of code "evaluates" to a result?
3. Think about how **if** statements relate to your decision-making process. What does the **if** statement for choosing your outfit in the morning look like (using **if** / **elif** / **else** to reach a conclusion)?

Additional Resources

1. [All Built-In Functions](#)
2. [HackerRank, Python Challenges](#)

- » Try these challenges to practice your Python skills.